

Chapter 22-1

Liang Shi didn't know how the original body got along with her family members.

Currently, she had only spoken with Qiu Zimin over the phone.

But through the brief content she already knew, both of the original body's brothers were actually quite decent—they were just exasperated by the original body's unruly behavior, feeling disappointed that she couldn't live up to expectations, so they eventually grew tired of dealing with her.

Especially after the Liang family recognized their new daughter, their attitude toward her plummeted to rock bottom.

But then again, it was the original body's own fault for being such a disappointment.

In the latter half of the novel, when the original body had her glands gouged out¹ and thrown onto the streets, utterly destitute, she even went as far as kidnapping Liang Xinhe's daughter, attempting to threaten this second brother who had been tolerant of her since childhood, hoping to get some money to flee far away.

This infuriated Liang Xinhe so much that after rescuing his daughter, he directly had someone break one of the original body's legs.

Liang Shi: "....."

For some reason, Liang Shi felt a sympathetic sensation at this moment.

As if the person whose leg was broken was herself.

She shivered.

"No," Liang Shi said. "I'm staying at home."

The implication being—I'm being very well-behaved, not running around or going gambling.

"I heard you were hospitalized a couple days ago?" Liang Xinhe said. "Together with your wife, no less. What kind of terrible thing did you do this time?"

Liang Shi swallowed, "Nothing, just... a small misunderstanding."

"I'm too lazy to meddle in your affairs." Liang Xinhe's tone was impatient, but what he said was sensible. "You're the one who married her back into the family. Our family paid no small price to let you marry her, so don't go acting foolishly. If you end up provoking the Xu family and they use media power to attack the Liang family, I definitely won't stand on your side."

"Understood." Liang Shi promised. "I'll treat Xu Qingzhu well."

"Whatever happens between you two wives is none of my business," Liang Xinhe said. "But are you still coming to the company or not? If not, I'll remove your position to save us from having an empty office taking up space and annoying people."

Liang Shi immediately said, "I'll come."

She didn't have anything else to do right now anyway, and returning to her old profession would also take some time.

While she didn't understand this world very well, she couldn't act rashly.

Moreover, acting required a lot of time. In the past, once she joined a film crew, she would basically be cut off from the outside world.

Right now, she still needed to win over Xu Qingzhu—in other words, she couldn't stray too far from Xu Qingzhu, otherwise she wouldn't be able to gain fortune points and would die.

For these three months, she'd better lay low.

People, you have to bow to reality.

"But second brother, could you change my position?" Liang Shi tried to make a request.

Liang Xinhe said impatiently, "What position? Isn't a forty-square-meter office comfortable enough? My general manager's office is about the same size as yours. Liang Shi, that's enough—don't push your luck."

"No," Liang Shi said. "Second brother, I want to change departments."

Liang Xinhe: "?"

A few seconds later, Liang Xinhe asked with genuine sincerity, "With your abilities, which department do you think you could go to?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She coughed awkwardly, "How about starting from the bottom?"

Being an actor also required frequent life experience.

In the past, to play a delivery worker, she had actually worked delivering food.

She had also worked at an advertising company as a low-level employee for a month, set up street stalls, and run a spicy hot pot shop.

That's why audiences often said she looked like whatever she played—she was whatever she portrayed.

She could give people a sense of authenticity.

Right now, she'd just consider it as experiencing life.

"Let me work as a regular employee," Liang Shi said. "You don't need to give me such a big office, and you don't need to give me special privileges. I'll just work incognito as a regular employee, learning from the most basic level."

Liang Xinhe was truly shocked this time.

After a moment, he asked, "If you've been kidnapped, blink?"

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Never mind, I can't see you anyway," Liang Xinhe said. "So which department do you want to go to?"

Liang Shi had just looked up Dongheng Group, so she wasn't completely unfamiliar with it.

But if asked which specific department she wanted to go to, she really didn't know.

However...

She had a sudden inspiration: "Which department researches new products?"

"R&D?" Liang Xinhe dismissed the idea. "You don't know anything—don't go there to cause trouble."

Liang Shi: "....."

But Liang Xinhe thought of a good place for her: "You can go to the magazine department."

"What does that do?" Liang Shi asked.

"A new department that Dongheng established last month. They're planning to launch our own publication, specializing in digital magazines. Currently, this department is short-staffed, so you can go help out. If they need copywriting, you might be able to help a bit. I thought you hadn't learned anything in university, but I didn't realize you could still write poetry." After Liang Xinhe finished speaking, he added, "Liang Shi, you're the one who said you wanted to turn over a new leaf. I'm giving you a chance—don't cause any trouble at the company later."

Liang Shi: ".....Okay."

Liang Xinhe instructed her to report to the Human Resources department on Monday for reassignment, then hung up the phone.

Liang Shi looked at the time—it was already Saturday.

She could start work soon.

Footnotes:

¹ **Glands gouged out:** In ABO dynamics, refers to the violent removal of scent glands, which permanently damages an Alpha or Omega's ability to produce pheromones and form bonds—considered an extremely cruel punishment.

Chapter 22-2

//

Near evening, Xu Qingzhu received a phone call from Bai Weiwei.

Afterward, she hurriedly drove out.

Xu Qingya watched her retreating figure and asked in confusion, "What happened?"

But she got no answer.

At that time, Liang Shi was in her room preparing materials she'd need for work. The original body's graduation certificate had been thrown into some corner by her, and Liang Shi had to search for quite a while to find it.

Back then, the original body had attended a diploma mill¹—she only had a graduation certificate, no degree certificate.

However, the photo on the graduation certificate was quite youthful and eye-catching.

Shoulder-length hair, a radiant smile.

Liang Shi sighed—time really was a merciless killer.

And photos really could be deceiving.

Anyone looking at it would never think the person in the photo was a profligate wastrel with cruel methods.

She organized everything neatly, then went downstairs.

Only Xu Qingya was in the living room. She asked, "Where's your sister?"

"She just went out," Xu Qingya said. "It seems Sister Weiwei had something urgent to discuss with her."

Liang Shi: "I see."

She didn't think much of it.

But at nine o'clock in the evening, Xu Qingzhu still hadn't returned.

Liang Shi waited in her room for quite a while, glancing toward the door from time to time.

At some moment, for some reason, she felt like she had become a "waiting wife stone"².

She was so bored that she had already removed the carpet and found a new one from another room to lay down.

Stepping on the soft carpet, she always felt like something was about to happen.

At nine-twenty, Liang Shi couldn't help but call Xu Qingzhu.

It kept ringing, but no one answered.

She sent several WeChat messages.

Still no response.

Text messages were the same.

She found a jacket and went downstairs. The first floor was empty and eerily quiet.

Her footsteps on the solid wood stairs made clicking sounds.

Cold and lonely.

The unease in Liang Shi's heart grew stronger.

She called Xu Qingzhu's number again—it went straight to voicemail.

Just as she was about to call again, she received a multimedia message.

It was from an unknown number. The photo showed a dimly lit private room filled with swirling smoke, where a group of people sat around a circular table—both men and women, all wearing dissolute smiles on their faces.

Bai Weiwei and Xu Qingzhu sat under the dim yellow lighting. Bai Weiwei was clearly drunk, and Xu Qingzhu wasn't much better off.

In front of them were six wine glasses and a dice.

Liang Shi frowned and was about to ask where this was.

The other party had already sent a message.

【Liang Shi, you're about to be cheated on.】

Liang Shi: 【Who are you? Where is this?】

A few seconds later, a text came: 【Your wife is playing Russian roulette³ with people at Huayue International.】

【If you're much later, who knows whether they'll be spinning for drinks or people.】

Footnotes:

¹ **Diploma mill:** A term for institutions that grant degrees with little or no academic study required, often considered to have no academic credibility.

² **Waiting wife stone:** A Chinese idiom referring to a legendary rock formation said to resemble a woman waiting for her husband's return—used metaphorically to describe someone waiting anxiously for a loved one.

³ **Russian roulette:** Here referring to a drinking game where participants spin to determine who drinks, but the sender implies it might escalate to more dangerous activities.